

WHY I'M ORAKZAI

“I’m Orakzai” is more than the title of a book. It is a statement of identity.

For me, Orakzai represents a connection to a place, a people, a history, and a way of understanding community. It connects the present with generations who lived through difficult circumstances, protected their traditions, raised families, and carried their identity from one generation to the next.

I grew up knowing that identity is not something that exists only in a name. It is carried through language, family, memory, customs, relationships, and the stories people tell about where they came from.

The Orakzai identity is part of my own story, but this book is not intended to speak for every Orakzai or define the experience of an entire community through one person's perspective. Instead, it is an attempt to learn, document, question, and understand.

That distinction matters.

History is complicated. Communities change. Memories can differ. Some stories are preserved through written records, while others survive through families and oral tradition. I want this book to respect both the importance of documented evidence and the value of cultural memory, while making clear where the two differ.

I also believe that heritage should not prevent progress.

A person can carry the traditions of their ancestors while studying computer science, building technology, creating businesses, exploring artificial intelligence, or working with blockchain. Modern technology does not have to erase cultural identity. It can also become a tool for preserving it.

This is why the story of Orakzai belongs not only to the past.

IT BELONGS TO THE FUTURE.

The younger generation has an opportunity to preserve languages, document family histories, digitize archives, build new institutions, create businesses, and connect communities across borders.

My hope is that “I’m Orakzai” can contribute to that conversation.

Not by romanticizing the past.

Not by rewriting history.

But by asking a simple question:

How can we remember where we came from while building where we are going?

For me, the answer begins with two words:

I’m Orakzai.

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

This book is ultimately a journey between heritage and possibility — from mountains and villages to cities, universities, technology, entrepreneurship, and the digital world.

The distance between these worlds is large, but identity can travel across it.

I carry my roots with me.

And I believe the future should know where those roots began.

